Amiodarone

**** This monograph is under review ****

FORM Ampoules containing 150mg/3ml (50mg/ml) Concentrate solution for infusion

INDICATION Ventricular Arrhythmias

DOSE RANGE

AGE	DOSE	FREQUENCY	ROUTE
1 to 6 months	5mg/kg over 4 hours	Loading dose	IV Infusion
	Initially **5micrograms/kg/minute** Increase according to response to a maximum dose of **15micrograms/kg/minute**	Continuous Infusion	IV

PRESCRIPTION OF CONTINUOUS INFUSION

SINGLE STRENGTH = 50mg/kg in 50ml Glucose 5%
This gives:-

- 5 microgram/kg/minute at 0.3ml/hour

DOUBLE STRENGTH (for babies weighing < 600grams)
= 100mg/kg in 50ml infusion fluid
This gives:-

- 10 microgram/kg/minute at 0.3ml/hour

(For stability purposes, a double strength infusion should be used for babies weighing less than 600grams)

RECONSTITUTION Not required

DILUTION

For continuous Infusion

SINGLE STRENGTH
Using 50mg/ml injection
1 x wt (kg) is the number of ml of amiodarone 50mg/ml to be diluted up to 50ml total with infusion fluid (equivalent to **50mg /kg in 50ml**)

DOUBLE STRENGTH
Using 50mg/ml injection
2 x wt (kg) is the number of ml of amiodarone 50mg/ml to be diluted up to 50ml total with infusion fluid (equivalent to **100mg/kg in 50ml**)

METHOD OF ADMINISTRATION

Loading Dose
5mg/kg can be administered as a separate infusion over 4 hours **OR** given from the infusion as prepared above
SINGLE strength - Give 5ml (5mg/kg) over 4 hours
DOUBLE strength – Give 2.5ml (5mg/kg) over 4 hours

For continuous Infusion
By continuous intravenous infusion, flow rate adjusted according to the baby's response (see prescription section for details).
Administration via a **central venous catheter** is recommended.

COMPATIBILITY

Solution compatibility	glucose 5% ONLY
Solution incompatibility	sodium Chloride
IV Line compatibility	adrenaline, clarithromycin, dopamine, fluconazole, gentamicin, hydralazine, labetalol, metronidazole, midazolam, milrinone, , morphine, noradrenaline, vancomycin, vecuronium, *Variable compatibility (dobutamine, insulin, magnesium sulphate, potassium chloride, sodium nitroprusside) Contact pharmacy for advice*
IV Line incompatibility	Imipenem, furosemide, heparin, meropenam, phenobarbital, phenytoin, sodium bicarbonate

THIS LIST IS NOT EXHAUSTIVE PLEASE CONTACT PHARMACY FOR FURTHER INFORMATION ON COMPATIBILITY WITH ANY MEDICINES NOT INCLUDED

CAUTIONS, CONTRA-INDICATIONS AND SIDE EFFECTS
See Summary of Product Characteristics and most recent edition of BNF for Children
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FURTHER INFORMATION

Monitoring requirements
- Liver function and thyroid-function tests required before treatment and then every 6 months.
- Serum potassium (risk of hypokalaemia)
- Blood pressure (circulatory collapse precipitated by rapid administration or over dosage).

Other Information
- This product may contain benzyl alcohol. Benzyl alcohol has been reported to be associated with a fatal "Gasping syndrome" in premature infants.
- Can cause photosensitivity (caution with phototherapy) and persistent slate-grey skin discolouration.

PH 3.5 – 4.5 (undiluted)

LICENSED STATUS Not licensed for use in children

APPLICABLE POLICIES West of Scotland Neonatal Guidelines

Consult local policy if applicable

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Administer reconstituted solutions immediately.
All vials, ampoules and infusion bags are for single use only unless otherwise stated.

Dose may vary depending on indication, age, renal function, hepatic function, and concomitant medications.
This monograph should be used in conjunction with the terms of reference document prepared by the West of Scotland Pharmacist Network. Information is correct at the time of publication and as per local practice agreement.
For further advice please contact your clinical pharmacist or pharmacy department